madaris and militant organizations.[59] Deobandi madaris and militant outfits were major beneficiaries of this domestic and foreign largesse, which contributed to a growing Deobandi infrastructure. Because the central government was also channeling Saudi aid toward Deobandi militant groups to fight in Afghanistan, coupled with unofficial Saudi funding delivered to these groups directly, this helped to forge a nexus between sectarianism in Pakistan and attachment to the Afghan theater for many of the Deobandi jihadi outfits.[60] Some Pakistan-based scholars have also argued that Deobandi Islam in Pakistan and Afghanistan moved away from its Indian roots in part due to the influence of Saudi Wahhabism.[61]

The JUI took advantage of the situation to establish hundreds of madaris along the Pashtun belt that stretches across the NWFP and Balochistan. This contributed to a process of 'Pashtunization' in which Pashtunwali [the traditional Pashtun tribal code] fused with traditional Islamic interpretation.[62] With these madaris, the JUI was able to offer free education, food, shelter and military training to Afghan refugees and indigenous, but impoverished, Pakistanis. By the end of Zia's reign there were 8,000 official Deobandi madaris and an additional 25,000 unregulated ones.[63] As the quantity of madaris increased their quality declined and, in some cases, jihadi ideology built for mass consumption superseded traditional Islamic scholarship. One example of this phenomenon is the Darul Uloom Haqqania madrasa, headed by Sami ul-Haq. At least eight Taliban cabinet ministers and dozens more Taliban officials graduated from this madrasa. Another is the Jamiat-ul-Uloom-e-Islamiyah madrasa at Binori Town in Karachi, which also contributed a significant number of cadres to the ranks of the Taliban.[64]

In 1980, three students left the madrasa at Binori Town and headed for Afghanistan. There they founded a small group named Jamiat-ul-Ansar [Society of the Partisans] to take part in the jihad against the Soviets. The group was renamed Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami [The Islamic Jihad Movement or HuJI] in 1988, after which it redirected its energies toward the Kashmir jihad. Following differences among the leadership, a splinter faction known as the Harkat-ul-Mujahideen [Movement of the Holy Warriors] emerged. This group also entered the Kashmir theater. The two later reunited briefly, before splitting once again in 1997. Two years later, HuM also splintered and another group called Jaish-e-Mohammad [Army